

Willard Robinson

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Education

North Carolina State University , Ph.D. Economics	2027 (expected)
Committee: Spencer Banzhaf (advisor), Erin Sills , Roger von Haefen , Zhenxuan Wang	
Montana State University , M.S. Applied Economics	2022
Appalachian State University , B.A. Economics (<i>summa cum laude</i>)	2020
Minor: Mathematics	

Research fields

Fields: Environmental and natural resource economics, environmental markets, nonmarket valuation

Working papers

- Asymmetric Information and Transaction Costs in Voluntary Conservation Markets* (**Job market paper**) [\[PDF\]](#)
- Adoption Costs for Offsets: Evidence from California* [\[PDF\]](#)
- Under review
 - First place, *William D. Toussaint Best Paper Award*, NC State Economics Department

Works in progress

- Recreation Welfare Effects with Climate Change-Induced Migration*
- Impacts of Centralized Budget Policy on National Parks: An analysis of the Federal Land Recreation Enhancement Act*
- The Value of Shoreline Recreational Fishing Across Time and Space: An internal meta-regression approach* (with [Sasha Naumenko](#), [Colton Leach](#), and [Roger von Haefen](#))
- Stability in Centralized College Major Assignment* (with [Umut Dur](#))

Research experience

CEnREP Graduate research assistant for Prof. Spencer Banzhaf	Jan. 2024–present
• “Making Markets Work” • “The Marke for Environmental Offsets”	
Graduate research assistant for Prof. Umut Dur	Jan. 2025–Jan. 2026
• “Stability in Centralized College Major Assignment”	
Graduate research assistant for Prof. Nick Hagerty	Aug. 2020–May 2022
• “Anticipatory Effects of Regulating the Commons” with Ellen Bruno (2025), <i>Journal of Environmental Economics and Management</i>, vol. 132: 103183	
Research assistant for Prof. John Whitehead	Jun. 2019–May 2020
• Non-market valuation	
Research assistant for Prof. Brock Stoddard	Jun. 2019–May 2020
• Experimental economics	

Teaching experience

U. = Undergraduate course, Ph.D. = Doctorate course

Instructor

NC State University

ARE 336 (U.): *Introduction to Environmental and Resource Economics* Fall '25

Montana State University

ECNS 202 (U.): *Principles of Macroeconomics* Fall '21, Spring '22

Graduate teaching assistant

NC State University

ARE 336 (U.): *Introduction to Environmental and Resource Economics* Fall '23, Spring '25, Fall '26

ARE 301 (U.): *Intermediate Microeconomics* Fall '26

ECG 702 (Ph.D.): *Microeconomic Theory II* Spring '24

EC 201 (U.): *Principles of Microeconomics* Fall '22, Spring '22, Fall '23

Head TA in Fall '23

Montana State University

ECNS 202 (U.): *Principles of Macroeconomics* Summer '21, Summer '22

ECNS 403R (U.): *(Honors) Introductory Econometrics* Fall '20

Seminars and conference presentations (including scheduled*)

Asymmetric Information and Transaction Costs in Voluntary Conservation Markets

Camp Resources XXXII (2026), AERE @ the Southern Economic Association (2026), Appalachian State University (2026), East Carolina University (2026), North Carolina State University (2026)

Adoption Costs for Offsets: Evidence from California

NCSU Economics Third Year Workshop (2026)

Impacts of Centralized Budget Policy on National Parks: An analysis of the Federal Land Recreation Enhancement Act

Property and Environment Research Center (2025), Appalachian Experimental and Environmental Workshop (2024)

Recreation Welfare Effects with Climate Change-Induced Migration

NCSU Graduate Student Seminar Series (2025)

Awards and fellowships

Andrew J. & Thelma K. Bartley Endowed Graduate Fellowship, 2026
Poole College of Management

NBER travel grant 2026

First place, Best Paper Award, Department of Economics 2026

PERC graduate summer fellowship, **Property and Environment Research Center** 2025

Top student in economics, Appalachian State University 2020

Professional activities

Referee service

AERE @ the Southern Economic Association conference, Environmental Research Letters

University service

Graduate student seminar organizer, NCSU 2025–present

Vice President, Economics Graduate Student Association, NCSU 2024–present

Membership

American Economic Association

Association of Environmental and Resource Economists

European Association of Environmental Resource Economists

Technical skills

Computing: Julia, Git, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Matlab, R, SAS, Stata

References

Spencer Banzhaf

Professor

North Carolina State University

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Roger von Haefen

Professor

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Zhenxuan Wang

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